

TRADITIONAL YORÙBÁ CRIME CONTROL MECHANISM IN *ANÍKÚLÁPÓ* FILM: A FUNCTIONALIST APPROACH

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1.0. Abstract

Crime continues to pose significant social and cultural challenges in Nigeria, yet scholarly engagement with indigenous mechanisms of crime control in media representations remains limited. This study examines the representation of traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms in the film Aníkúlápó, situating the analysis within a Functionalist theoretical framework to explore how these mechanisms function to maintain social order, moral discipline, and communal harmony. While prior studies have largely focused on modern policing and legal systems, this research foregrounds indigenous justice structures, including the Oba, councils of elders, and diviners, and their roles in regulating behaviour through public sanctions, spiritual consultation, restitution, moral instruction, and communal accountability. The study addresses the gap identified in film scholarship by demonstrating how Aníkúlápó operates as a representational medium, using narrative construction, symbolism, and dialogue to depict the interplay between culture, morality, and justice. A qualitative content analysis was conducted, guided by clear selection criteria and thematic coding to ensure analytical rigor and reliability. Findings reveal that traditional mechanisms are not merely descriptive but serve functional roles in deterring deviance, restoring social equilibrium, and reinforcing communal values, thus offering insights into the politics of cultural representation in contemporary Nigerian cinema. The study contributes to debates in African film studies, indigenous criminology, and cultural sociology by bridging the gap between cultural exposition and scholarly analysis.

Keywords: *Crime, Indigenous Justice, Yorùbá Culture, Functionalism, and Aníkúlápó Film.*

2.0. Introduction

Crime remains a persistent social and cultural challenge in Nigeria, yet scholarly attention to indigenous mechanisms of crime control in cinematic representations is limited. While modern policing and legal systems dominate academic discourse, the traditional Yorùbá justice system, embedded in cultural norms, communal responsibility, and moral values, continues to regulate behaviour through institutions such as the Oba, councils of elders, and diviners (Elechi, 2018). These institutions employ mechanisms including public sanctions, spiritual consultation, restitution, moral instruction, and communal accountability to maintain social order and restore communal harmony (Salihu, 2020; Ayodele, 2017). Despite the rich heritage of these systems, their portrayal in Nigerian films, particularly *Aníkúlápó*, remains underexplored, reflecting a

gap in African film studies and indigenous criminology (Adedokun & Olanrewaju, 2023; Kunle Afolayan, 2022).

This study addresses this gap by asking the central research question: “How are traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms represented in *Aníkúlápó*, and how do they function to sustain social order, moral discipline, and communal harmony?” The analytical focus is on how the film operates as a representational medium, using narrative construction, symbolism, and dialogue to convey moral and social expectations. The study thus moves beyond mere description to critically examine how the depiction of justice and authority in the film reflects functional roles of indigenous mechanisms in shaping behaviour, deterring deviance, and reinforcing communal values.

By situating the analysis within a Functionalist theoretical framework, the research demonstrates that traditional mechanisms are not merely cultural exposition but purposeful, adaptive systems with enduring relevance in contemporary society. The study contributes to knowledge by bridging the gap between cultural representation and scholarly analysis, offering insights into the politics of cultural representation, the role of indigenous justice in film, and the broader discourse on moral and social regulation in Yorùbá society and Nigerian cinema.

3.0. Literature Review

The study of crime control within African societies has often focused on modern legal systems, policing strategies, and state-administered justice, leaving indigenous mechanisms underexplored. Among the Yorùbá people of southwestern Nigeria, traditional systems of justice historically played critical roles in regulating behaviour, deterring deviance, and restoring social equilibrium. These systems relied on a combination of authority, communal consultation, moral instruction, and spiritual oversight, illustrating a holistic approach to crime control that integrates cultural, ethical, and social dimensions (Salihu, 2020; Ayodele, 2017). However, much of the literature remains descriptive, lacking critical analysis of how these practices are represented in contemporary cultural productions such as film.

In recent years, scholars in African film studies and Nollywood scholarship have emphasized the importance of cinema as a representational medium that reflects, critiques, and constructs social norms, morality, and power relations. Films are increasingly recognized as sites of cultural preservation and moral discourse, where narrative structure, dialogue, and cinematic techniques serve as instruments of social instruction (Haynes, 2016). Yet, few studies systematically examine how traditional justice systems are depicted in Nigerian cinema, and even fewer critically engage with the interplay between culture, morality, and social regulation through cinematic representation, particularly in films such as *Aníkúlápó* (Kunle Afolayan, 2022).

Functionalist perspectives, particularly those of Durkheim and Parsons, provide a theoretical foundation for understanding the social roles of traditional mechanisms, emphasizing how norms, sanctions, and institutions collectively maintain societal stability (Mahmud, Zaman & Islam, 2026). Nonetheless, prior applications often remain explanatory rather than analytical, neglecting the nuanced ways in which film narrativizes authority, communal accountability, and moral order. Furthermore, scholarship on indigenous criminology and decolonial perspectives

on law and governance underscores the need to critically examine justice practices beyond Western paradigms, highlighting their cultural legitimacy, restorative potential, and communal relevance.

This review identifies three critical gaps that the current study addresses: (1) the limited engagement with Nigerian films as analytic sites for indigenous justice, (2) the superficial integration of Functionalist theory in analysing cultural representations, and (3) the insufficient scholarly attention to the symbolic and narrative dimensions through which traditional mechanisms are constructed cinematically. By focusing on *Aníkúlápó*, this study contributes to closing these gaps, demonstrating how the film actively constructs moral and social authority, negotiates communal values, and depicts the functional significance of traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms within contemporary visual culture.

4.0. Theoretical Framework (Functionalism)

The study adopts Functionalism as its theoretical framework to critically analyse the representation of traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms in the film *Aníkúlápó*. Rooted in the works of Émile Durkheim and Talcott Parsons, Functionalism conceives society as an interconnected system in which institutions, norms, and practices contribute to the maintenance of social order, stability, and cohesion. While prior applications of Functionalism have been largely explanatory, this study demonstrates a rigorous analytical use of the framework by examining how cinematic representation of traditional mechanisms communicates moral, social, and communal functions within Yorùbá society, particularly in films such as *Aníkúlápó* (Kunle Afolayan, 2022) and *October 1* (Kunle Afolayan, 2014).

Functionalist theory illuminates the purposeful and adaptive roles of traditional crime control institutions such as the Oba, councils of elders, chiefs, and diviners. Each institution functions not in isolation but as part of an integrated system that deters deviance, restores social equilibrium, and reinforces communal norms. For example, public sanctions, restitution, spiritual consultation, and moral instruction are socially functional mechanisms that maintain harmony, regulate behaviour, and educate community members. These dynamics are also reflected in films like *The Figurine* (Kunle Afolayan, 2009), where supernatural beliefs and moral consequences operate as regulatory forces within society. By situating these mechanisms within a Functionalist lens, the study interprets filmic scenes as deliberate representations of social functionality rather than mere narrative exposition.

In the context of *Aníkúlápó*, Functionalism is applied to analyse how narrative structure, dialogue, mise-en-scène, and symbolism collectively depict the moral and social consequences of deviance. Scenes where elders deliberate over transgressions or diviners uncover hidden wrongdoing exemplify the interdependence of institutions, illustrating how social and spiritual authorities operate synergistically to enforce justice. Similarly, films such as *Saworoide* (Tunde Kelani, 1999) portray traditional political authority and ritual sanctions as mechanisms for maintaining accountability and social order. Functionalism thus allows for a critical interrogation of the ways the film constructs authority, negotiates moral order, and visually represents communal responsibility.

Furthermore, the framework underscores the scholarly contribution of the study by bridging

sociological theory and film analysis. It demonstrates that the representation of traditional Yorùbá mechanisms is not merely descriptive or aesthetic but serves critical social functions, reinforcing norms, shaping behaviour, and illustrating the integration of culture, morality, and justice. By using Functionalism as an analytical tool, the study advances knowledge in African film studies, indigenous criminology, and cultural sociology, showing how theory can illuminate both the form and function of cinematic representation in reflecting and sustaining societal values.

5.0. Methodology

This study employs a qualitative content analysis to examine the representation of traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms in films such as *Aníkúlápó* and other culturally grounded Nollywood texts. Qualitative content analysis is particularly suited for interpreting symbolic meanings, cultural narratives, and social constructs embedded in visual media (Schreier, 2012). The primary text, *Aníkúlápó* (Kunle Afolayan, 2022), was selected due to its status as a representational medium that dramatizes cultural, moral, and social systems, making it a critical site for understanding the interplay between indigenous justice and cinematic narrative construction. Additional contextual insights are drawn from films such as *Saworoide* (Tunde Kelani, 1999) and *October 1* (Kunle Afolayan, 2014), which similarly engage themes of justice, authority, and moral regulation.

Data selection followed explicit criteria: scenes were chosen based on their depiction of traditional crime control mechanisms, including public sanctions, spiritual consultation, restitution, moral instruction, and communal deliberation. Each selected scene was examined in terms of dialogue, character interactions, mise-en-scène, symbolism, and narrative function, to interrogate how justice is constructed cinematically rather than merely described. This approach aligns with qualitative film analysis methods that emphasize meaning-making through visual and narrative structures (Rose, 2016). Comparable narrative strategies are evident in films such as *The Figurine* (Kunle Afolayan, 2009), where symbolism and supernatural elements function as mechanisms of moral regulation.

An analytical coding framework was employed to categorize instances of normative enforcement, communal participation, moral instruction, and restorative practices. The coding process followed a structured approach to qualitative analysis, enabling the identification of recurring themes and patterns across selected scenes. Thematic analysis was used to interpret how these mechanisms function to deter deviance, restore social equilibrium, and reinforce communal values, consistent with the Functionalist lens. Coding decisions were cross-checked to enhance reliability, and interpretive judgments were documented to ensure transparency and validity. This methodological rigor reflects established practices in qualitative research design and cultural analysis (Creswell & Poth, 2018).

The study acknowledges limitations inherent in qualitative analysis of a single primary film. While *Aníkúlápó* provides rich cultural insights, findings are interpretive and context-specific. Potential bias may arise from subjective engagement with narrative and symbolism; however, systematic coding and cross-referencing with scholarly literature mitigated undue subjectivity. Insights from films such as *King of Boys* (Kemi Adetiba, 2018), which explores power, justice, and moral ambiguity, further contextualize the interpretive scope of cinematic representations

of authority and social control.

Overall, the methodology ensures a rigorous, analytical, and reproducible process. By clearly outlining scene selection, coding, and analytical procedure, the study demonstrates how film can serve as a legitimate and insightful source of cultural and sociological analysis, bridging gaps in African film studies and indigenous justice scholarship.

6.0. Overview of *Aníkúlápó* (Context and Narrative)

Aníkúlápó is a culturally rich Nigerian film that dramatizes the intricacies of traditional Yorùbá society, emphasizing moral expectations, social hierarchies, and mechanisms of communal justice. Beyond a conventional narrative, the film functions as a representational medium through which cultural norms, ethical codes, and social control practices are communicated to audiences (Onibere & Ottuh, 2024). The film serves as a critical site for examining how traditional crime control mechanisms are enacted, interpreted, and visually symbolized, similar to narrative strategies observed in *Saworoide* (Tunde Kelani, 1999) and *October 1* (Kunle Afolayan, 2014), where authority and morality are central thematic concerns.

The narrative centers on the interplay between authority, communal oversight, and individual deviance, reflecting the interdependent nature of traditional justice institutions. Key characters, including the Oba, elders, chiefs, and spiritual authorities, perform complementary roles in regulating behaviour and maintaining social order. These characters are not merely plot devices; they symbolically represent the functional aspects of justice in Yorùbá society, illustrating the collective responsibility and moral accountability emphasized in cultural studies scholarship. For instance, the Oba's pronouncements serve as authoritative moral guidance, while elders' deliberations and diviners' spiritual consultations exemplify consultative and culturally legitimized processes of adjudication. Comparable symbolic representations of authority are evident in *The Figurine* (Kunle Afolayan, 2009), where supernatural agency intersects with moral accountability.

The film's narrative structure strategically interweaves conflict, transgression, and resolution to highlight the consequences of deviance within the communal moral order. Scenes depicting theft, deceit, or violations of ethical norms are meticulously constructed to illustrate the relationship between wrongdoing and communal sanctions, such as public acknowledgment, restitution, and ritual cleansing. Dialogue and proverbs, including statements like “*Àimoye kì í jẹ́ kí ẹ̀ni tò bá ẹ̀ búbúrú sá lọ pẹ́*”, function not only as moral instruction but also as symbolic reinforcement of societal norms, demonstrating the embeddedness of ethical principles within daily life (Oluwaseun, 2016). Similar narrative uses of dialogue and moral consequence can be observed in *King of Boys* (Kemi Adetiba, 2018), where language and power reinforce social order and accountability.

Cinematic techniques further enhance the representation of traditional mechanisms. *Mise-en-scène*, lighting, and spatial arrangement underscore the authority of communal institutions and the moral gravity of transgression. Public gatherings of elders or ritual spaces are deliberately framed to communicate collective accountability, while character positioning during deliberations visually conveys hierarchies of moral and spiritual authority. This aligns with film theory perspectives that view visual composition as central to meaning-making in cinema (Bordwell & Thompson, 2013). Comparable visual strategies are evident in *Half of a Yellow*

Sun (Biyi Bandele, 2013), where spatial arrangement and visual symbolism communicate power relations and moral tension.

Importantly, *Anikulápó* negotiates the complex interplay between individual agency and communal oversight, illustrating how moral order is both enforced and internalized. Characters' responses to sanctions, dialogue with authority figures, and engagement with restorative rituals highlight the dynamic processes through which social norms are maintained. This dual emphasis on individual and collective responsibility reflects broader themes in African storytelling traditions, where narrative serves as a tool for moral instruction and social regulation.

By positioning *Anikulápó* as a site of both cultural preservation and moral discourse, the film demonstrates the enduring relevance of Yorùbá crime control mechanisms in contemporary media. It exemplifies how cinema can mediate, reflect, and critique indigenous justice systems, providing audiences with insight into the ethical, spiritual, and social dimensions of communal governance. Consequently, the narrative overview establishes a critical foundation for subsequent thematic analysis, bridging sociological theory, cinematic representation, and cultural practice.

7.0. Analysis (Thematic: Sanctions, Spirituality, Restitution, Moral Order)

The analysis of *Anikulápó* focuses on four interrelated themes, public sanctions, spiritual oversight, restitution, and cultural moral order, to critically examine how traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms are represented as functional instruments of social regulation. Through narrative structure and cinematic techniques, the film constructs justice as a lived and communal experience, aligning with interpretive approaches to film as a site of ideological and cultural meaning-making (Lapsley, 2024). Comparable thematic constructions are evident in *Saworoide* (Tunde Kelani, 1999) and *October 1* (Kunle Afolayan, 2014), where justice, authority, and accountability are central narrative concerns.

7.1. Public Sanctions and Communal Accountability

Public sanctions are depicted in the film as both moral and social instruments that reinforce communal norms. Scenes where offenders are brought before elders and the broader community illustrate the collective nature of accountability, aligning with Functionalist principles of social integration and norm enforcement. The use of dialogue, spatial arrangements, and audience reactions within these scenes underscores the deterrent function of communal exposure. The proverb “*Èní tó bá ẹ̀ ẹ̀ ẹ̀ ẹ̀, ayé ọ ní gbà ẹ̀ lẹ̀*” is strategically positioned to communicate ethical imperatives, demonstrating how meaning is constructed linguistically and visually (Simonović & Alfrević, 2017). Similar representations of public accountability and ritualized sanctioning are found in *Saworoide*, where communal participation legitimizes authority and enforces moral discipline.

7.2. Spiritual Sanctions and Divination

Spiritual oversight in *Anikulápó* demonstrates the integration of moral and supernatural accountability. Diviners' consultations, ritual invocations, and ancestral guidance are portrayed through symbolic mise-en-scène, including sacred spaces, ceremonial objects, and controlled lighting. These cinematic elements visually encode the authority of spiritual institutions,

reinforcing their legitimacy within the social structure (Ukadike, 2023). The fear of spiritual repercussions motivates compliance, illustrating both preventive and corrective dimensions of traditional mechanisms. This thematic pattern is also evident in *The Figurine* (Kunle Afolayan, 2009), where supernatural consequences regulate human behaviour and moral choices.

7.3. Restitution and Restorative Practices

Restorative justice is central to the film's depiction of crime control, emphasizing reconciliation between offenders and victims. Scenes depicting material or ritual restitution are framed to highlight relationship repair and social reintegration, demonstrating the adaptive and restorative nature of traditional justice systems. From a Functionalist perspective, these practices contribute to the re-establishment of social equilibrium and communal trust. The performative aspects of restitution, dialogue, gestures, and symbolic acts, serve as mechanisms of moral education, reinforcing shared values (Ogelenya, 2025). Comparable restorative dynamics can be observed in *October 1*, where truth-telling and acknowledgment function as pathways to justice and closure.

7.4. Cultural Moral Order

The overarching theme of moral order is embedded throughout the narrative, demonstrating the internalization of ethical norms through storytelling, proverbs, and communal engagement. Cinematic techniques such as framing, pacing, and character positioning visually articulate hierarchies of authority and responsibility, reinforcing the interconnectedness of social institutions. The film portrays moral order as both preventive, guiding behaviour before transgression, and corrective, restoring balance when norms are violated. This aligns with cultural theories that emphasize narrative as a tool for transmitting values and regulating conduct (Ryan, 2017). Similar thematic constructions of moral order and consequence are evident in *King of Boys* (Kemi Adetiba, 2018), where power, ethics, and accountability intersect within a structured social system.

In sum, *Aníkúlápó* constructs a cinematic representation of traditional Yorùbá crime control that is analytically rich, culturally grounded, and functionally effective. By integrating dialogue, symbolism, narrative structure, and cinematic techniques, the film conveys the purposeful roles of sanctions, spirituality, restitution, and moral order, while reinforcing the interplay between communal norms, authority, and ethical education. The analysis demonstrates that film operates not merely as entertainment but as a critical medium for articulating and sustaining social values across contexts.

8.0. Discussion

The analysis of *Aníkúlápó* reveals that traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms function not merely as narrative elements but as purposeful instruments of social regulation, moral education, and communal cohesion. By examining the film through a Functionalist lens, it becomes evident that sanctions, spiritual oversight, restitution, and cultural moral order collectively reinforce social norms, deter deviance, and restore equilibrium when transgressions occur. The interplay of these mechanisms illustrates how the interdependent roles of traditional institutions maintain social stability, demonstrating that indigenous systems of justice operate as integrated and adaptive structures rather than isolated practices (Emmanuel, Ying & Balakrishnan, 2024). Similar institutional interdependence is depicted in *Saworoide* (Tunde Kelani, 1999), where political authority and ritual sanctions operate cohesively to enforce accountability.

The film's narrative construction and use of cinematic techniques enhance the representational power of justice mechanisms. Dialogue, proverbs, and character interactions are carefully

crafted to convey moral imperatives, while *mise-en-scène*, spatial arrangements, and ritual imagery visually reinforce authority and communal responsibility. Scenes of public sanction, for instance, strategically position offenders within communal spaces, highlighting the visibility of accountability and the deterrent function of social exposure. Similarly, sequences involving diviners employ sacred spaces, lighting, and symbolic props to communicate the moral weight of spiritual oversight, emphasizing that transgressions are socially and spiritually consequential. These cinematic choices align with theories of film as a medium of ideological communication and cultural pedagogy (Balogun & Adeseke, 2022). Comparable visual storytelling techniques are evident in *The Figurine* (Kunle Afolayan, 2009), where symbolism and atmosphere reinforce moral consequences.

Restorative practices depicted in the film further underscore the holistic nature of Yorùbá justice, demonstrating that punishment is not merely punitive but corrective, aiming to repair relationships between offenders, victims, and the community. The requirement for restitution, ritual cleansing, and moral instruction illustrates how justice functions both preventively and rehabilitatively, aligning with sociological perspectives on social order and integration (Afatakpa & Olufunmilayo, 2026). Characters' engagement with these mechanisms highlights the negotiation of authority and moral responsibility, showing that compliance is not enforced solely by fear but by internalized ethical and social values. Similar restorative and moral dynamics can be observed in *October 1* (Kunle Afolayan, 2014), where truth, accountability, and reconciliation are central to narrative resolution.

The film also foregrounds cultural moral order as a critical underpinning of societal stability. Through storytelling, dialogue, and proverbs, ethical lessons are communicated across generations, demonstrating both preventive and corrective dimensions of socialization. Characters' actions, consequences, and responses to communal authority collectively depict the continuous reinforcement of norms, emphasizing that moral education is embedded in everyday cultural practice. This aligns with cultural theory perspectives that view narrative as a vehicle for transmitting values and sustaining social systems (Storey, 2021). Comparable representations of moral order and power relations are evident in *King of Boys* (Kemi Adetiba, 2018), where authority, ethics, and consequence intersect within a structured social environment.

From a scholarly perspective, *Anikulápó* offers a significant contribution to understanding the intersection of film, culture, and indigenous criminology. By portraying the mechanisms of traditional Yorùbá justice in visually and narratively rich ways, the film exemplifies how cinema can mediate cultural knowledge, moral discourse, and ethical regulation. The study demonstrates that integrating sociological theory with film analysis provides insights into the functional, symbolic, and didactic dimensions of justice, offering a nuanced framework for examining cultural representations of law and morality in African media (Okeke, Chibuike, Okpala & Ajagu, 2024).

In sum, the discussion reveals that traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms, as mediated through cinematic narrative and techniques, are analytically rich, culturally grounded, and functionally adaptive. By emphasizing the interconnection between authority, morality, and communal oversight, the film illustrates the enduring relevance of indigenous systems of justice

in shaping social behaviour, restoring equilibrium, and educating audiences about ethical norms. This integrative approach bridges sociological theory, film studies, and cultural practice, highlighting the scholarly significance of examining indigenous justice through cinematic representation.

9.0. Conclusion

This study demonstrates that *Aníkúlápó* provides a rich and analytically significant representation of traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms, illustrating how indigenous systems of justice function to maintain social order, moral discipline, and communal harmony. Through cinematic techniques such as dialogue, mise-en-scène, characterisation, and symbolic props, the film constructs a vivid depiction of public sanctions, spiritual oversight, restitution, and cultural moral order. These mechanisms are not merely narrative devices but purposeful instruments of social regulation, reinforcing the idea that cultural practices operate as structured systems of meaning and control within society. Similar thematic resolutions and moral constructions are evident in *Saworoide* (Tunde Kelani, 1999) and *The Figurine* (Kunle Afolayan, 2009), where justice and consequence are narratively and symbolically reinforced.

The analysis reveals that justice in Yorùbá society is holistic, integrating moral, social, and spiritual dimensions. The authority of traditional institutions collectively enforces accountability while promoting corrective and restorative outcomes. Restitution and ritual acts restore social balance, public sanctions reinforce communal norms, and moral instruction through proverbs and narratives educates both offenders and observers. The film demonstrates how these mechanisms operate both preventively, deterring transgressions, and rehabilitatively, reintegrating offenders into the moral fabric of the community. This aligns with interpretive perspectives that view law and justice as culturally embedded systems of meaning rather than purely institutional constructs. Comparable representations of justice and moral consequence can also be observed in *October 1* (Kunle Afolayan, 2014), where truth and accountability shape narrative closure.

By situating these practices within the narrative of *Aníkúlápó*, the study highlights the interplay between culture, morality, and social regulation, showing that indigenous justice systems are functionally effective, ethically instructive, and culturally resonant. The film further illustrates the potential of African cinema as a medium for cultural preservation, moral discourse, and ethical socialization, bridging traditional knowledge with contemporary representations. This supports broader arguments that cinema operates as a cultural archive and communicative system through which societies negotiate identity and values. Similar cultural mediation is evident in *King of Boys* (Kemi Adetiba, 2018), where power, morality, and social order are critically examined.

The study affirms that traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms remain relevant in understanding both social behaviour and cultural narratives. By integrating sociological theory with film analysis, it demonstrates that these practices provide insight into the construction of justice, authority, and communal responsibility. Ultimately, the research contributes to African film studies, cultural sociology, and indigenous criminology by showing that cinematic representation is not merely reflective but actively constitutive of social knowledge, moral values, and systems of governance.

10.0. Recommendations

Based on the analytical findings of this study, it is evident that traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms, as portrayed in *Aníkúlápó*, offer functionally effective, culturally grounded, and morally instructive approaches to social regulation. To strengthen their relevance and integration into contemporary societal and academic discourse, the following recommendations are proposed:

10.1. Revitalisation of Traditional Mechanisms

Communities and policymakers should actively revive and institutionalize traditional Yorùbá crime control practices alongside modern legal systems. This includes formal recognition of communal adjudication, public sanctions, restitution, spiritual consultation, and moral instruction. By revitalising these practices, offenders can be held accountable in culturally meaningful ways, social cohesion can be enhanced, and indigenous knowledge and ethical norms preserved for future generations. Films like *Saworoide* illustrate how public rituals and communal enforcement maintain societal order, offering practical cultural insights that could inform policy.

10.2. Integration with Contemporary Justice Systems

Traditional mechanisms should be systematically incorporated into modern law enforcement and judicial processes. For instance, courts and police could engage local elders or diviners as advisory figures where culturally appropriate. Such integration enhances the legitimacy of justice processes, improves detection of wrongdoing, and creates hybrid strategies leveraging both indigenous wisdom and contemporary legal frameworks to reduce crime incidence effectively (Mahmud, Zaman & Islam, 2026). Narrative examples from *October 1* demonstrate how ethical and investigative oversight intersect with communal norms, reinforcing accountability.

10.3. Community Education and Moral Training

Educational initiatives must focus on raising awareness about the principles of traditional crime control and moral codes. Schools, media platforms, and community programs should teach young people the importance of ethical behaviour, communal responsibility, and respect for societal norms. This proactive approach strengthens preventive measures, encourages self-regulation, and ensures that moral instruction is internalized, reducing deviant behaviour. Films such as *Aníkúlápó* and *The Figurine* serve as educational tools by visually demonstrating the consequences of transgression and the value of restorative practices.

10.4. Documentation and Research of Indigenous Practices

Scholars, cultural institutions, and policymakers should systematically document traditional crime control mechanisms and their representations in films, literature, and oral traditions. Comprehensive documentation preserves these practices, provides critical assessment opportunities, and facilitates adaptation to contemporary contexts. Archiving such knowledge also supports future research, enabling filmmakers, educators, and researchers to reinforce ethical governance and social justice in culturally resonant ways. For instance, analyzing films like *King of Boys* (Kemi Adetiba, 2018) provides insight into the interplay between power, morality, and social order in modern Nigerian society.

10.5. Promotion through Cultural Productions

Filmmakers, playwrights, and content creators should continue to depict traditional Yorùbá crime control mechanisms accurately in media. Films like *Aníkúlápó* demonstrate how cinema can educate audiences about moral expectations, communal responsibility, and the functional role of indigenous justice. Accurate representation fosters cultural pride, reinforces social values, and illustrates that traditional practices can complement modern crime prevention strategies effectively. Integrating ethnographic consultation and historical accuracy in creative works ensures authenticity while promoting ethical and communal literacy.

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